Warm-up / Only the helpful headlines

Check the evidence you prefer

Name: _____ Date: _____

Suggested lesson time: 30 minutes. Work individually, then compare when invited.

Useful words

Confirmation bias: A tendency to favor information that fits what we already believe or want to believe.

Evidence standard: A rule for judging evidence quality, applied consistently to different conclusions.

Read the scenario

Invented scenario: Mina believes morning classes help learning. She saves three headlines agreeing with her and ignores two disagreeing headlines because she says, 'I only want support for my view.' She has not read any study methods.

Produce: Write the selection pattern and one fair next step.

Your steps

1. Identify which evidence Mina accepts and avoids.
2. Explain how that choice favors her existing view.
3. Propose a next step that uses the same evidence standards for both sides.

Before you finish: Have you identified the stated behavior without declaring her belief true or false?

Your response

Main activity / Does the study app help?

Name: _____

Read the scenario

Invented scenario: After buying a study app, Sam reads six glowing reviews and skips four detailed critical reviews because 'they will only make me doubt my choice'. Sam concludes the app must improve learning. No learning results have been collected.

Produce: Write the selection pattern, a three-step checking plan, and a learning measure with an explanation.

Your steps

1. Identify the evidence Sam selects and the evidence Sam avoids, and explain the direction of the preference.
2. Write a three-step checking plan: include both kinds of reviews, use the same quality criteria for them, and collect a learning measure rather than relying only on praise.
3. Name a specific learning measure, such as a delayed quiz on comparable material, and say why review popularity alone is insufficient.

Before you finish: Does your plan make it possible to discover that the purchase was unhelpful, or only reassure Sam?

Your response

Exit ticket / Defending a new planner

Name: _____

Read the scenario

Invented scenario: After buying a planner app, Jo reads eight positive reviews and ignores three detailed complaints because 'I do not want to regret buying it'. Jo concludes the app reduces missed deadlines. No deadline records have been collected.

Produce: Write the biased selection and a three-step checking plan with a relevant measure.

Your steps

1. Identify the evidence Jo chooses and avoids, and the direction of the preference.
2. Plan to read both kinds of review and apply the same quality criteria.
3. Name a comparison using missed deadlines. You may compare rates: missed deadlines divided by total deadlines, using comparable workloads and periods. Explain why positive reviews alone do not answer the claim.

Before you finish: Could the plan reveal that the app does not reduce missed deadlines?

Your response